

North Korean involvement in the Russo-Ukrainian war (2022–present)

North Korea has been involved in the Russo-Ukrainian war since 2017, escalating from diplomatic support to arms deliveries from 2023, and deployment of Korean People's Army units to assist Russia in the Kursk campaign from 2024.

In 2017, North Korea recognized the 2014 Russian annexation of Crimea. In July 2022, North Korea recognized the self-proclaimed Donetsk People's Republic and the Luhansk People's Republic. Since 2023, North Korea has supplied Russia with materiel, primarily artillery and missiles. From October 2024, North Korea sent military personnel to Russia^[1] who fought the Armed Forces of Ukraine in the Kursk campaign inside Russia, in Russian uniforms and under Russian command.

Supplied materiel is estimated at millions of artillery shells worth several billions of dollars, over a hundred Hwasong-11A and Hwasong-11B short-range ballistic missiles, and smaller numbers of M-1989 Koksan self-propelled howitzers and other shorter-range missiles.

The forces deployed to Russia, estimated at 12,000 to 15,000 troops, are believed to be primarily from the Korean People's Army Special Operations Forces. The first clashes with Ukrainian troops occurred in early November, and by mid-January Western officials estimated their casualties at 4,000 and deaths at 1,000. Postulated motives for North Korea's involvement include Russian supplies of rice, technology for the North Korean space program, and other assistance countering sanctions against North Korea, and to gain combat experience for its soldiers. Suggested Russian motives include addressing a shortage of labor in construction, factories, and in troop counts, and preventing a full-scale mobilization.

Diplomatic support for Russia

North Korea repeatedly sided with Russia during the Ukraine conflict. The country officially recognized Crimea as part of Russia as early as 2017, thereby supporting Moscow's position at the international level.^[2]

With the escalation of the conflict and the start of the Russian invasion of Ukraine, North Korea continued its support for Russia. In July 2022, North Korea recognized the independence of the self-proclaimed Donetsk and Luhansk People's Republics, supported by Russia. This decision immediately led to the severance of diplomatic relations between Ukraine and North Korea.^[3]



Russian President Vladimir Putin (left) and North Korean leader Kim Jong Un (right) at the Forbidden City in Pyongyang during the North Korea–Russia summit in June 2024

Ukraine condemned North Korea's recognition of the separatist territories as a serious breach of international law and an undermining of the country's territorial integrity. In an official statement, the Ukrainian Foreign Ministry said that North Korea's decision had no legal relevance.^[3]

Relations between Ukraine and North Korea were almost non-existent even before these events. International sanctions against North Korea had prevented any form of cooperation. The official diplomatic break in 2022 was therefore more symbolic.^[4]

Arms deliveries to Russia

During the Russian-Ukrainian war, North Korea had supported Russia with artillery ammunition, initially drawing on old stocks. These deliveries could explain the high failure rate of up to 50% in the use of this ammunition documented by Ukraine. At the same time, North Korea had its arms industry running at full speed, and it was estimated that it was able to produce up to two million artillery shells annually, making a significant contribution to Russia's warfare.^[5]

In mid-November 2024, almost 50 North Korean-made M-1989 Koksan self-propelled howitzers and around 20 M-1991 short-range missile systems were delivered to Russia to reinforce the Russian armed forces in the conflict with Ukraine.^{[6][7]}



North Korea's M-1989 Koksan howitzer, a long-range artillery weapon supplied to Russia to bolster its artillery capabilities in its invasion of Ukraine.

In an interview with The Korea Herald, Wi Sun Lak, the former South Korean ambassador to Russia, stated that North Korea's participation in the war against Ukraine was beneficial to North Korea. According to Wi, Russia's support of North Korea helps ease economic problems such as the financial and food crises, as Moscow pays compensation. According to South Korean intelligence, the sale of several containers of artillery shells could enable North Korea to purchase hundreds of thousands of tons of rice. Officials also reported that Russia may be helping North Korea develop space technology.^[8] The Council on Foreign Relations reported in November 2025 that North Korea had supplied Russia with a total of 12 million artillery shells by July 2025.^[9] Open Source Centre, a British think tank, reported from satellite imagery that between September 2023 and April 2025, North Korea supplied 15,000 containers containing around 4 million shells, potentially worth "several billions of dollars".^[10]

In April 2025, Ukraine's Main Directorate of Intelligence claimed that North Korea had supplied Russia with 148 Hwasong-11A and Hwasong-11B short-range ballistic missiles up until the start of 2025. Ukrainian sources claimed the missiles carry up to one-ton warheads, heavier than their Russian equivalents, and that missile debris had been discovered in an attack on Kyiv.^[11]

Deployment of North Korean soldiers to Russia

Initial reports

In October 2024, multiple sources reported that North Korean soldiers were undergoing training in eastern Russia. The South Korean National Intelligence Service (NIS), which stated that around 1,500 soldiers had been sent for military training, possibly for deployment in Ukraine. In October 2024, NATO claimed that it had evidence that North Korean soldiers had been sent to Russia.^[12] Ukrainian military intelligence HUR, claimed that the first North Korean soldiers arrived in the Russian Kursk Oblast on October 25, 2024.^{[13][14]} On 28 April 2025, North Korea confirmed that they have sent troops to Russia.^[15]



Russian minister of defense Sergei Shoigu meeting with North Korean minister of defense Kang Sun-nam on 25 July 2023

Force size and nature

North Korea is said to have decided to send around 12,000 troops, including special forces, to support Russia in the Ukraine conflict, including around 500 officers and three generals.^{[16][17]} The Council of Foreign Relations assessed that the majority of were from the KPA's Special Operations Forces,^{[18][19]} other sources also assessed they were from an elite unit.^[20]

Nevertheless, the quality of the North Korean troops preparing for deployment in the war in Ukraine has been viewed critically.^[21] Ants Kiviselg, the commander of the Estonian Defense Ministry's intelligence center, stated that North Korean soldiers are usually trained to fight in mountainous terrain and have no experience of operating in Ukraine. He pointed out that they are unfamiliar with the climatic conditions and geography on the ground. He also claimed that the quality of their training in Russia is not high.^[22] Kateryna Stepanenko, an analyst at the Institute for the Study of War (ISW), pointed out that the term "elite" may not apply for North Korean troops.^[23] Despite these assessments, there were voices warning against underestimating the North Korean soldiers.^[24]

Ukraine informed the UN Security Council that Russia allegedly intended to integrate at least five North Korean brigades, each with 2,000 to 3,000 soldiers, into its armed forces. According to reports from the US Department of Defense, allegedly about 10,000 North Korean soldiers had arrived in the border region of Kursk by the end of October 2024. Purportedly among the North Korean units is also Colonel General Kim Yong Bok, the commander of North Korea's special forces and a close confidant of Kim Jong Un.^[25]

South Korean intelligence has alleged that North Korean soldiers deployed in Russia will receive a monthly salary of around \$2,000.^[26] Ahn Chang Il, a former lieutenant in the North Korean army, alleged that North Korean soldiers deployed to Russia saw their participation in the conflict in Ukraine as an opportunity for social advancement and financial improvement for their families. He also emphasized that the North Korean government promised incentives such as joining the Workers' Party of Korea, necessary for advancement in North Korea.^[27]

Training and mobilization

The North Korean soldiers received their training at the Russian military training areas in Ussuriysk, Ulan-Ude and Knyazye-Volkonskoye, among other places.^[28] The soldiers were initially transported by Russian ships to Vladivostok, where they received Russian uniforms and fake identities to conceal their true origin.^{[13][14]} They had previously been trained at several locations in eastern Russia. The coordination and training, which lasts several weeks, is reportedly led by Russia's deputy defense minister Yunus-bek Yevkurov. Russia is providing the soldiers with ammunition, winter clothing, and hygiene products.^[29] Employees of the North Korean embassy were also purportedly taken to a training ground. These apparently took on translation tasks and supervised the soldiers during the exercises.^[30] They were transported from Vladivostok to a military airfield in western Russia in Ilyushin Il-76 transport planes and then flown to the combat zone.^[20] They were billeted in barracks about 50 kilometers from the border with Ukraine.^[31]

Effect on bilateral ties

At a meeting with Russian foreign minister Sergey Lavrov in Moscow on 1 November 2024, North Korean foreign minister Choe Son-hui announced that her country would continue to provide military support to Russia until the day of the final victory over Ukraine. In this context, Lavrov underlined the close cooperation between the military and security agencies of the two countries.^[32] According to Choe Son-hui, North Korean leader Kim Jong-un ordered unconditional support for Russian forces and civilians in a “holy war” from the very beginning of the conflict.^[33] In view of the deployment of North Korean soldiers to support Russia in the Ukraine conflict, Choe Son-hui then met with Russian president Vladimir Putin in Moscow on 4 November.^[34] On 6 November, the Russian Federation Council approved a defense agreement with North Korea. The agreement stipulates that both countries will provide each other with military support in the event of an attack.^[35]



Russian Defense Minister Andrey Belousov with North Korean Defense Minister No Kwang-chol on 29 November 2024

The Atlantic Council reported that North Korean participation in the invasion allows the North Koreans to acquire priceless combat experience, test weapons systems, gain access to Russian military technologies, and secure Moscow's further assistance in countering UN sanctions.^[36]

Kursk campaign

According to a report in The New York Times on 5 November 2024, clashes between Ukrainian and North Korean troops occurred for the first time in the Kursk region of Russia. Ukrainian president Volodymyr Zelensky assessed this development as significant and spoke of a new dimension of global instability. However, the fighting is said to have been limited and corroborating evidence equally so.^[37]

In an interview with the South Korean television station KBS, the Ukrainian Defense Minister, Rustem Umierov, claimed that for the first time on skirmishes with North Korean fighters. However, he claimed that they were difficult to identify, as they were not only dressed in Russian uniforms, but also

purportedly disguised themselves as members of the Buryat ethnic group. Furthermore, he further claimed that the soldiers were fully integrated into the Russian army and operated under Russian command, which further complicated the determination of their actual identity.^[38]

On 11 January 2025, Ukraine announced to have captured two wounded North Korean soldiers from the Kursk region, which were the first two North Korean prisoners of the war. The South Korean National Intelligence Service confirmed the North Korean origin of the two prisoners.^[39] According to South Korean intelligence, North Korea had 300 killed and almost 2,700 wounded soldiers by January 2025.^[40] By mid-January the estimate rose, with anonymous Western officials telling the BBC that it is estimated 1,000 KIA, and a total of 4,000 casualties.^[41]

According to an NHK report filed on 19 February 2025, captured North Korean soldiers were told by their commanders that South Korean soldiers are present in Kursk alongside Ukrainian soldiers.^[42] They also mention inadequate Russian artillery cover, which led to their capture.^[42]

In April 2025, following the end of the Kursk campaign, the Russian and North Korean governments officially acknowledged North Korean involvement.^[43] Russian president Vladimir Putin lauded the North Korean soldiers as "heroic", and North Korean leader Kim Jong Un said that a monument to the Kursk offensive would be built in Pyongyang.^[44]

In June 2025, secretary of the Russian Security Council Sergei Shoigu announced that 1,000 North Korean military workers would be deployed to Kursk for demining, and another 5,000 for reconstruction.^[45]

In October 2025, the General Staff of the Ukrainian Armed Forces reported that North Korean soldiers based in Kursk are conducting recon operations with drones to help Russian soldiers identify targets.^[46]

On April 2026, on the first anniversary of the conclusion of the Kursk campaign, the North Korean government inaugurated a war memorial and museum commemorating its involvement in Ukraine, the Memorial Museum of Combat Feats at the Overseas Military Operations.^[47] At the opening ceremony, North Korean leader Kim Jong Un commended North Korean soldiers who "self-blasted" themselves with grenades to avoid being captured by Ukrainian forces.^[48]



Region in the Russian Kursk Oblast, where North Korean soldiers were deployed.

Alleged deployment into Ukraine

In November 2025, Ukrainian media, citing pro-war Russian bloggers and telegram channels, stated that North Korean soldiers have allegedly arrived in Ukraine's Zaporizhzhia region and may be preparing to fight near the town of Huliaipole. However, Ukrainian officials and Western intelligence agencies have not confirmed the presence of North Korean troops in Ukraine itself.^[49] On February 4, 2026, the DIU reported the presence of North Korean troops in the border regions from Kursk, targeting border communities.^[50]

North Korean labor

The BBC reported that, in 2024, more than 10,000 North Korean workers were sent to work in "slave-like conditions" in Russian construction and other sectors, "in violation of the UN sanctions banning the use of North Korean labour." A South Korean intelligence official told the BBC that as many as 50,000 workers were to be deployed in 2025.^[51] The Modern War Institute at West Point stated that 30,000 North Korean laborers were deployed to support the frontlines as of August 2025.^[52]

International reactions

Ukraine

Ukrainian president Volodymyr Zelenskyy stated that North Korea is indeed planning to send soldiers to Ukraine to fight alongside the Russian army. He criticized the lack of decisive action by Western allies as a motivation for Russian President Vladimir Putin to continue his "terrorist" actions in the conflict. Zelenskyy stated that North Korea had previously supported Russia in the war against Ukraine. He referred to US intelligence reports that North Korea had supplied Russia with three million artillery shells and missiles. Zelenskyy further stated that Russian president Vladimir Putin was avoiding large-scale mobilization in Russia because it could jeopardize his domestic political support. Instead, according to Zelenskyy, Putin sees North Korea as a strategic alternative. The North Korean leadership, in turn, sees this as an opportunity to give their soldiers combat experience in modern warfare. He also stated that Russia intends to use North Korean labor to address the shortage of labor not only in construction but also in military factories.^[53] Ukraine's representative to the UN, Serhiy Kyslytsia, warned the Security Council that the involvement of North Korean troops in Russia's war against Ukraine poses a serious threat to Europe and the Korean Peninsula.^[54]

Russia

Although North Korean troops were deployed to fight Ukrainian troops in early August 2024, Russia rejected the accusations of North Korean soldiers as "fake news". Putin later responded to questions about satellite images that allegedly indicated the presence of North Korean soldiers on Russian territory at a press conference on 24 October 2024, following the BRICS summit in Kazan, saying that "The images are serious. If there are images, then they reflect something." He also stated that the escalation of the situation in Ukraine was not caused by Russia's actions, but by the US-backed "coup" (Euromaidan) of 2014.^{[55][56]}

On 26 April 2025, following the end of the offensive, Russia's Chief of General Staff Valery Gerasimov finally confirmed North Korean involvement, stating:^{[43][57][58]}

Soldiers and officers of the Korean People's Army, fulfilling combat tasks shoulder to shoulder with Russian servicemen, in the course of repelling the Ukrainian incursion demonstrated high professionalism; and displayed resilience, courage, and heroism in battle.

In August 2024, Ukrainian forces crossed the border into Kursk Oblast during the Russo-Ukrainian War resulting in a small part of the oblast coming under Ukrainian occupation.^{[59][60]} In early April 2025, the Chief of Russia's General Staff Valery Gerasimov reported that the Kursk Oblast had been liberated from Ukrainian troops.^[61] In August 2024, Ukrainian forces crossed the border into Kursk Oblast during the Russo-Ukrainian War resulting in a small part of the oblast coming under Ukrainian occupation.^{[62][63]}

In September 2025, President Putin publicly thanked Kim Jong Un for the North Korean troops fighting against Ukraine.^[64] In December 2025, Kursk Oblast Governor Alexander Khinshtein announced the city of Kursk will build a memorial to celebrate the North Korean soldiers who had been deployed to defend Kursk against Ukraine. The monument, which received support from the Russian defense ministry, will be built in the city of Kursk and is dedicated to “the combat brotherhood of the DPRK and Russia.”^[65]

United States

US defense secretary Lloyd Austin expressed concern about the possible consequences of the deployment. The United States announced that it would take decisive action in response to North Korea's alleged military support for Russia in the Ukraine conflict. US secretary of state Antony Blinken said that North Korea could expect a “tough response” for the involvement of its troops in the fighting. He made the comments during a joint appearance with the NATO Secretary General in Brussels.^[66]

NATO

NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte warned of the geopolitical risks that could arise from increased military cooperation between North Korea and Russia, pointing out that this could further destabilize the dynamics of the war.^[67] On 28 October 2024, he spoke of a “significant escalation” in the Ukraine conflict due to the stationing of North Korean troops in the Kursk region. He said that the cooperation between Russia and North Korea endangers security in both the Indo-Pacific and the Euro-Atlantic area and further intensifies the war dynamic.^{[68][69]}

United Nations

UN Secretary-General António Guterres warned of a possible internationalization of the war.^[70]

Germany

During her trip to Kyiv on 4 November 2024, German foreign minister Annalena Baerbock emphasized that North Korea's military assistance to Russia was significantly exacerbating the situation, while President Putin continued to pursue a war of attrition to demoralize the population.^[71]

South Korea

On 7 November 2024, South Korean President Yoon Suk Yeol suggested that South Korea could provide weapons to Ukraine.^[72] However, the South Korean public was widely opposed to direct arms supplies to Ukraine.^[73]

See also

- [North Korea–Russia relations](#)
- [North Korea–Ukraine relations](#)

References

1. "North Korea confirms it sent troops to Russia, calling them 'heroes' " (<https://www.nbcnews.com/world/asia/north-korea-confirms-sent-troops-russia-calling-heroes-rcna203245>). *NBC News*. 28 April 2025. Retrieved 29 April 2025.
2. "Russian diplomats say North Korea has recognized Moscow's sovereignty over Crimea" (<https://meduza.io/en/news/2017/10/12/russian-diplomats-say-north-korea-has-recognized-moscow-s-sovereignty-over-crimea>). *Meduza*. Retrieved 19 November 2024.
3. Statement of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Ukraine regarding the severance of diplomatic relations with the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (<https://mfa.gov.ua/en/news/zayava-mzs-ukrayini-shchodo-rozrivu-diplomatichnih-vidnosin-iz-korejskoyu-narodnoyu-demokratičnoyu-respublikoyu>) *Ukrainian Foreign Ministry*
4. "Ukraine Cuts Ties With North Korea Over Recognition Of Separatist Territories" (<https://www.rferl.org/a/ukraine-north-korea-separatists/31942138.html>). *rferl.org*. 13 July 2022. Retrieved 23 October 2024.
5. Suh, Elisabeth (21 October 2024). "Nordkoreas Rüstungspolitik als indirekte Sicherheitsbedrohung für Europa" (<https://www.swp-berlin.org/10.18449/2024A53/>). *SWP-Aktuell*. doi:10.18449/2024A53 (<https://doi.org/10.18449%2F2024A53>). Retrieved 18 November 2024.
6. "Nordkorea liefert Russland offenbar auch Artillerie" (<https://www.tagesschau.de/ausland/europa/nordkorea-russland-artillerie-100.html>). *tagesschau.de*. 17 November 2024. Retrieved 18 November 2024.
7. Krotovska, Olga (18 November 2024). " "Не будемо сидіти склавши руки": Південна Корея готує відповідь на солдат КНДР в росії" (<https://weukraine.tv/novyny/ne-budemo-siditi-sklavshi-ruki-pivdenna-koreja-hotuje-vidpovid-na-soldat-kndr-v-rosiji/>). *weukraine.tv*. Retrieved 19 November 2024.
8. Arin, Kim (3 November 2024). "\$200m a year, 700,000 tons of rice, space tech: The deal for North Korea in joining Russia's war" (<https://news.koreaherald.com/view.php?ud=20241103050116>). *koreaherald.com*. Retrieved 4 November 2024.
9. Carlough, Molly; Kennedy, James. "How North Korea Has Bolstered Russia's War in Ukraine" (<https://www.cfr.org/article/how-north-korea-has-bolstered-russias-war-ukraine>). *Council of Foreign Relations*. Retrieved 29 November 2025.
10. Team, O. S. C. "Brothers in Arms" (<https://stories.opensourcecentre.org/brothers-in-arms/>). *stories.opensourcecentre.org*. Retrieved 7 May 2026.
11. McCurry, Justin (25 April 2025). "From ammunition to ballistic missiles: how North Korea arms Russia in the Ukraine war" (<https://www.theguardian.com/world/2025/apr/25/how-north-korea-arms-russia-in-ukraine-war>). *The Guardian*. ISSN 0261-3077 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0261-3077>). Retrieved 7 May 2026.
12. "Doorstep statement by NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte following the North Atlantic Council briefing on the DPRK's troop deployment to Russia" (https://www.nato.int/cps/en/natohq/opinions_230105.htm). *NATO*. 28 October 2024. Retrieved 19 November 2024.

13. Kennedy, Niamh; Yee, Isaac; Butenko, Victoria (19 October 2024). "North Korean troops seen being equipped in Russia ahead of likely deployment to Ukraine" (<https://edition.cnn.com/2024/10/19/asia/north-korea-ukraine-russia-troops-uniform-intl/index.html>). *CNN*. Retrieved 12 January 2025.
14. Denisova, Kateryna (17 October 2024). "'First step to World War' — North Korea preparing 10,000 soldiers to join Russia's war, Zelensky confirms" (<https://kyivindependent.com/north-korea-preparing-10-000-soldiers/>). *The Kyiv Independent*. Retrieved 12 January 2025.
15. "North Korea confirms it sent troops to Russia, calling them 'heroes'" (<https://www.nbcnews.com/world/asia/north-korea-confirms-sent-troops-russia-calling-heroes-rcna203245>). *NBC News*. 28 April 2025. Retrieved 29 April 2025.
16. "Schickt Nordkorea Soldaten nach Russland?" (<https://www.tagesschau.de/ausland/europa/nordkorea-russland-soldaten-faq-100.html>). *Tagesschau*. 23 October 2024. Retrieved 23 October 2024.
17. Novikov, Illia; Lukatsky, Efrem (25 October 2024). "Ukraine's Zelenskyy says North Korean troops are poised to join the war, cancels UN chief's visit" (<https://apnews.com/article/russia-ukraine-war-north-korea-troops-9d83c419ef741259d09860b576b8a27d>). *AP News*. Retrieved 12 January 2025.
18. Valerio, Helen Regan; Yoonjung Seo, Mike (18 December 2024). "Indoctrinated, loyal and well trained: Don't underestimate North Korean soldiers in Russia, experts say" (<https://www.cnn.com/2024/12/17/asia/north-korean-soldiers-russia-intl-hnk/index.html>). *CNN*. Retrieved 27 January 2025.
19. Carlough, Molly; Kennedy, James. "How North Korea Has Bolstered Russia's War in Ukraine" (<https://www.cfr.org/article/how-north-korea-has-bolstered-russias-war-ukraine>). *Council of Foreign Relations*. Retrieved 29 November 2025.
20. Chizhnyak, Julia (26 October 2024). "Перша партія північнокорейських солдатів уже в Курській області" (<https://www.rfi.fr/uk/%D0%BC%D1%96%D0%B6%D0%BD%D0%B0%D1%80%D0%BE%D0%B4%D0%BD%D1%96-%D0%BD%D0%BE%D0%B2%D0%B8%D0%BD%D0%B8/20241026-%D0%BF%D0%B5%D1%80%D1%88%D0%B0-%D0%BF%D0%B0%D1%80%D1%82%D1%96%D1%8F-%D0%BF%D1%96%D0%B2%D0%BD%D1%96%D1%87%D0%BD%D0%BE%D0%BA%D0%BE%D1%80%D0%B5%D0%B9%D1%81%D1%8C%D0%BA%D0%B8%D1%85-%D1%81%D0%BE%D0%BB%D0%B4%D0%B0%D1%82%D1%96%D0%B2-%D1%83%D0%B6%D0%B5-%D0%B2-%D0%BA%D1%83%D1%80%D1%81%D1%8C%D0%BA%D1%96%D0%B9-%D0%BE%D0%B1%D0%BB%D0%B0%D1%81%D1%82%D1%96-%E2%80%93-the-nyt>). Retrieved 27 October 2024.
21. Yoon, Dasl; Martin, Timothy W.; Lytvynenko, Jane (27 October 2024). "North Korean Soldiers Arrive on Russia's Front Line. How Ready Are They to Fight?" (https://www.wsj.com/world/asia/north-korean-soldiers-arrive-on-russias-front-line-how-ready-are-they-to-fight-84f885fa?mod=WSJ_Euronews). *The Wall Street Journal*. Retrieved 29 April 2025.
22. "Великих змін не буде. Війська КНДР можуть зазнати у війні проти України ще більших втрат, ніж РФ — естонська розвідка" (<https://nv.ua/ukr/world/geopolitics/uchast-viyskovih-kndr-u-viyni-proti-ukrajini-pivnichna-koreya-mozhe-zaznati-shche-bilsh-vtrat-nizh-rosiya-50463199.html>). *nv.ua*. 1 November 2024. Retrieved 1 November 2024.
23. Frazivir, Anna (30 October 2024). "КНДР на війні в Україні: для чого Росії північнокорейські військові та чи змінять вони хід бойових дій" (<https://suspilne.media/869365-kndr-na-vijni-v-ukraini-dla-cogo-rosii-pivnicnokorejski-vijskovi-ta-ci-zminat-voni-hid-bojovih-dij/>). *suspilne.media*. Retrieved 2 November 2024.
24. Salmon, Andrew (31 October 2024). "Underestimating North Korean troops is a mistake, experienced military officials warn" (<https://www.washingtontimes.com/news/2024/oct/31/underestimating-north-korean-troops-mistake-experi/>). *washingtontimes.com*. Retrieved 1 November 2024.

25. "Putins Truppen rücken auf Industriestadt Pokrowsk vor" (<https://www.spiegel.de/ausland/putins-truppen-ruecken-auf-die-pokrowsk-vor-a-4563b723-a6ee-4186-b2d5-f83d632232fa>). *spiegel.de*. 31 October 2024. Retrieved 31 October 2024.
26. Stepaniuk, Maria (3 November 2024). "Рис, космічні технології і не тільки: що КНДР отримає від Росії за відправлення своїх солдатів" (<https://fakty.com.ua/ua/svit/20241103-rys-kosmichni-tehnologiyi-i-ne-tilky-shho-kndr-otrymae-vid-rosiyi-za-vidpravlennya-svoyih-soldativ/>). *fakty.com.ua*. Retrieved 3 November 2024.
27. Zubaruk, Oleg (4 November 2024). "Нова мішень ЗСУ: перші солдати Північної Кореї стали ціллю українських захисників" (<https://expres.online/podrobitsi/nova-mishen-zsu-per-shi-soldati-pivnichnoi-korei-stali-tsillyu-ukrainskikh-zakhisnikiv>). *expres.online*. Retrieved 4 November 2024.
28. Levchenko, Oleksandr (29 October 2024). "КНДР постачає військових Росії: новий виклик для міжнародної безпеки" (<https://www.lrt.lt/ua/novini/1263/2400462/kndr-postachaie-viis-kovikh-rosiyi-novii-viklik-dlia-mizhnarodnoyi-bezpeki>). *lrt.lt*. Retrieved 1 November 2024.
29. "Erste nordkoreanische Soldaten offenbar in Kursk eingetroffen" (<https://www.spiegel.de/ausland/ukraine-krieg-erste-nordkoreanische-soldaten-offenbar-in-kursk-eingetroffen-a-1bc4f0a8-248d-481f-b6d5-0cefa95c3796>). *spiegel.de*. 25 October 2024. Retrieved 25 October 2024.
30. "Військові з КНДР почали злагодження на Курщині – ЦНС" (<https://www.slovoidilo.ua/2024/10/28/novyna/suspilstvo/vijskovi-kndr-pochaly-zlahodzhennya-kurshhyni-czns>). *slovoidilo.ua*. 28 October 2024. Retrieved 28 October 2024.
31. "FT: військові КНДР перебувають за 50 кілометрів від кордону з Україною" (<https://www.radiosvoboda.org/a/news-ft-vijskovi-kndr-kordon-ukrajiny/33179241.html>). *radiosvoboda.org*. 30 October 2024. Retrieved 30 October 2024.
32. "North Korea says it will stand by Russia until 'victory' in Ukraine" (https://www.lemonde.fr/en/international/article/2024/11/01/north-korea-says-it-will-stand-by-russia-until-victory-in-ukraine_6731246_4.html). *Le Monde*. 1 November 2024. Retrieved 19 November 2024.
33. Pischkin, Serhij (1 November 2024). "КНДР обіцяє "твердо стояти поруч" з Росією у війні проти України" (<https://www.rbc.ua/rus/news/kndr-obitsyae-tverdo-stoyati-poruch-rosieyu-1730455933.html/amp>). *rbc.ua*. Retrieved 1 November 2024.
34. "Putin Met North Korean Foreign Minister, Kremlin Says" (<https://www.themoscowtimes.com/2024/11/04/putin-met-north-korean-foreign-minister-kremlin-says-a86898>). *The Moscow Times*. AFP. 4 November 2024. Retrieved 19 November 2024.
35. "Federation Council ratifies Russian-N. Korean Treaty of Strategic Partnership" (<https://interfax.com/newsroom/top-stories/107423/>). *interfax.com*. Retrieved 19 November 2024.
36. Hrytsenko, Alina (23 January 2025). "North Korea is using Russia's Ukraine invasion to upgrade its army" (<https://www.atlanticcouncil.org/blogs/ukrainealert/north-korea-is-using-russias-ukraine-invasion-to-upgrade-its-army/>). *Atlantic Council*. Retrieved 17 March 2025.
37. Schwirtz, Michael; Barnes, Julian E. (5 November 2024). "North Korea Enters Ukraine Fight for First Time, Officials Say" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2024/11/05/world/europe/north-korea-russia-ukraine-kursk.html>). *The New York Times*.
38. "Offenbar erste Gefechte mit Truppen Nordkoreas" (<https://www.tagesschau.de/ausland/europa/ukraine-nordkorea-kriegshilfe-100.html>). *tagesschau.de* (in German). 6 November 2024. Retrieved 6 November 2024.
39. "Ukraine says 2 North Korean soldiers captured" (<https://www.dw.com/en/ukraine-says-2-north-korean-soldiers-captured/live-71273185>). *dw.com*. 12 January 2025. Retrieved 29 April 2025.
40. "Seoul says 300 North Korean soldiers killed, 2,700 wounded fighting Ukraine" (<https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2025/1/13/seoul-says-300-north-korean-soldiers-killed-2700-wounded-fighting-ukraine>). *Al Jazeera*. Retrieved 21 January 2025.

41. Gardner, Frank (22 January 2025). "About 1,000 North Koreans killed fighting Ukraine in Kursk, officials say" (<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c87djezjxeo>). *BBC News*. Retrieved 28 April 2025.
42. "ウクライナ捕虜の北朝鮮兵 "韓国軍が攻撃と聞かされていた" | NHK | ウクライナ情勢" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250219133330/https://www3.nhk.or.jp/news/html/20250219/k10014727501000.html>) [North Korean soldier held captive in Ukraine: "We were told South Korean troops were attacking"]. *NHK* (in Japanese). 19 February 2025. Archived from the original (<https://www3.nhk.or.jp/news/html/20250219/k10014727501000.html>) on 19 February 2025. Retrieved 26 March 2025.
43. Rajvanshi, Astha (27 April 2025). "Russia confirms North Korean troops are in Ukraine and claims Kursk region is retaken" (<https://www.nbcnews.com/world/ukraine/russia-confirms-north-korean-troops-kursk-rcna203137>). *NBC News*. Retrieved 27 April 2025.
44. Brennan, David (28 April 2025). "Putin says North Korean 'friends' helped Russia push Ukraine out of Kursk" (<https://abcnews.go.com/International/putin-north-korean-friends-help-ed-russia-push-ukraine/story?id=121229750>). *ABC News*. Retrieved 28 April 2025.
45. "North Korea to send military construction workers, deminers to rebuild Russia's Kursk region" (<https://www.france24.com/en/europe/20250617-north-korea-to-send-military-construction-workers-and-deminers-to-russia>). *AFP*. 17 June 2025. Retrieved 12 August 2025.
46. "North Korean troops flying drones into Ukraine to support Russian strikes: Kyiv | NK News" (<https://www.nknews.org/2025/10/north-korean-troops-flying-drones-into-ukraine-to-support-russian-strikes-kyiv/>). 17 October 2025.
47. Zwirko, Colin. "Kim Jong Un sets April opening for Ukraine war cemetery and museum" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20260321151206/https://www.nknews.org/2026/03/kim-jong-un-sets-april-opening-for-ukraine-war-cemetery-and-museum/>). *NK News*. Archived from the original (<https://www.nknews.org/2026/03/kim-jong-un-sets-april-opening-for-ukraine-war-cemetery-and-museum/>) on 21 March 2026.
48. "North Korea: Kim Jong Un praises troops who 'self-blasted' to avoid capture" (<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cddp7pzqdvjo>). *www.bbc.com*. 29 April 2026. Retrieved 30 April 2026.
49. Litnarovych, Vlad (24 November 2025). "Russia Claims North Korean Forces Have Reached the Frontline in Ukraine for the First Time" (<https://united24media.com/latest-news/russia-claims-north-korean-forces-have-reached-the-frontline-in-ukraine-for-the-first-time-13717>). *United24*. Retrieved 25 November 2025.
50. Yonhap (5 February 2026). "N. Korean troops still active in Russia's Kursk region against Ukraine: report" (<https://www.koreatimes.co.kr/foreignaffairs/northkorea/20260205/n-korean-troops-still-active-in-russias-kursk-region-against-ukraine-report>). *The Korea Times*. Retrieved 11 March 2026.
51. Mackenzie, Jean (12 August 2025). "North Koreans tell BBC they are being sent to work 'like slaves' in Russia" (<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c2077gwjlvxo>). *BBC*. Retrieved 12 August 2025.
52. Martin, Jared (8 August 2025). "The Second North Korean Wave in Ukraine: What Next as Pyongyang's Troops Arrive on Russia's Front Lines?" (<https://mwi.westpoint.edu/the-second-north-korean-wave-in-ukraine-what-next-as-pyongyangs-troops-arrive-on-russias-front-line-s/>). *Modern War Institute at West Point*. Retrieved 13 November 2025.
53. Tsyupin, Bohdan (1 November 2024). "Україна дорікає партнерам за "нульову" відповідь на участь Північної Кореї в російській війні" (<https://www.holosameryky.com/a/7847390.html>). *holosameryky.com*. Retrieved 1 November 2024.
54. "Кислиця в ООН: участь солдатів КНДР у війні є найнебезпечнішим розвитком подій за останній час" (<https://www.slovoidilo.ua/2024/10/31/novyna/polityka/kyslycyia-onn-uchast-soldativ-kndr-vijni-ye-najnebezpechnishym-rozvytkom-podij-ostannij-chas>). *slovoidilo.ua*. 31 October 2024. Retrieved 31 October 2024.

55. Kinsha, Daria (27 October 2024). "Росіяни перевозять на фронт солдат КНДР у вантажівках з цивільними номерами — ГУР" (<https://suspilne.media/amp/867063-rosiani-perevozat-na-front-soldat-kndr-u-vantazivkah-z-civilnimi-nomerami-gur/>). *suspilne.media*. Retrieved 27 October 2024.
56. "Пентагон: солдати з КНДР, ймовірно, посилять війська РФ поблизу України протягом наступних кількох тижнів" (<https://www.radiosvoboda.org/a/news-kndr-soldaty-rosiya-viyna-pentahon/33176724.html>). *radiosvoboda.org*. 28 October 2024. Retrieved 28 October 2024.
57. Munster, Ben (26 April 2025). "Russia claims complete 'liberation' of Kursk, admits North Korea assistance" (<https://www.politico.eu/article/kremlin-claims-complete-liberation-kursk-admits-north-korea-assistance-ukraine-war/>). *Politico*. Retrieved 29 March 2026.
58. Linke, Nikolai (26 April 2025). "For the First Time, Russian Authorities Admit Participation of North Korean Soldiers in the War" Власти РФ впервые признали участие солдат КНДР в войне (<https://www.dw.com/ru/vlasti-rf-vpervye-priznali-ucastie-soldat-kndr-v-vojne/a-72365968>). *Deutsche Welle* (in Russian). Retrieved 26 April 2025.
59. "Russia says it's battling a major cross-border assault by Ukraine" (<https://www.nbcnews.com/news/world/kursk-incursion-russia-battles-ukraine-border-attack-putin-war-rcna165497>). *NBC News*. 7 August 2024. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20240807125305/https://www.nbcnews.com/news/world/kursk-incursion-russia-battles-ukraine-border-attack-putin-war-rcna165497>) from the original on 7 August 2024. Retrieved 7 August 2024.
60. "Russia says forces repel Ukrainian armoured raid in Kursk region" (<https://www.reuters.com/world/europe/russian-forces-thwart-ukrainian-attempt-penetrate-border-regional-governor-says-2024-08-06/>). *Reuters*. 7 August 2024.
61. "Russia's military chief reports on complete liberation of Kursk Region" (<https://tass.com/defense/1949879>). *TASS*. 26 April 2025.
62. "Russia says it's battling a major cross-border assault by Ukraine" (<https://www.nbcnews.com/news/world/kursk-incursion-russia-battles-ukraine-border-attack-putin-war-rcna165497>). *NBC News*. 7 August 2024. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20240807125305/https://www.nbcnews.com/news/world/kursk-incursion-russia-battles-ukraine-border-attack-putin-war-rcna165497>) from the original on 7 August 2024. Retrieved 7 August 2024.
63. "Russia says forces repel Ukrainian armoured raid in Kursk region" (<https://www.reuters.com/world/europe/russian-forces-thwart-ukrainian-attempt-penetrate-border-regional-governor-says-2024-08-06/>). *Reuters*. 7 August 2024.
64. Mackintosh, Thomas; Jean Mackenzie, Jean (3 September 2025). "Putin thanks Kim for North Koreans fighting in Ukraine" (<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cj9w9m1xz1go>). *BBC*. Retrieved 10 December 2025.
65. Sokolin, Anton (December 2025). "Russia's Kursk set to build memorial for North Korean troops who fought Ukraine" (<https://www.nknews.org/2025/12/russias-kursk-set-to-build-memorial-for-north-korean-troops-who-fought-ukraine/>). *NK News*. Retrieved 6 December 2025.
66. "Blinken kündigt »harte Antwort« auf Nordkoreas Unterstützung für Russland an" (<https://www.spiegel.de/ausland/ukrainekrieg-antony-blinken-kuendigt-harte-antwort-auf-nordkoreas-unterstuetzung-fuer-russland-an-a-d9b7da42-1611-4c9d-81d0-394160910b74>). *spiegel.de*. 13 November 2024. Retrieved 13 November 2024.
67. Kölling, Martin (24 October 2024). "Wie stark ist Nordkoreas Armee wirklich, und welche neuen Risiken entstehen mit dem Russland-Bund?" (<https://www.nzz.ch/international/nordkorea-und-die-ukraine-darum-ist-kim-jong-uns-armee-fuer-putin-interessant-ld.1854237>). *Neue Zürcher Zeitung*. Retrieved 24 October 2024.
68. "NATO-Generalsekretär: Nordkorea hat Soldaten in Region Kursk" (<https://apa.at/news/nato-generalsekretaer-nordkorea-hat-soldaten-in-region-kursk/>). *apa.at*. 28 October 2024. Retrieved 28 October 2024.

69. "US-Regierung rechnet mit 10.000 nordkoreanischen Soldaten in Russland" (<https://www.spiegel.de/ausland/nordkorea-sendet-wohl-10-000-soldaten-nach-russland-zum-einsatz-an-ukrainischer-grenze-a-e82b6f44-4e59-40bc-a5a1-a54d27310c62>). *spiegel.de*. 28 October 2024. Retrieved 29 October 2024.
70. "Guterres warnt vor Einsatz nordkoreanischer Soldaten im Ukrainekrieg" (<https://www.spiegel.de/ausland/ukraine-antonio-guterres-warnt-vor-moeglichem-einsatz-nordkoreanischer-soldaten-a-a97018f5-aad2-4259-b039-caab8aa727a4>). *spiegel.de*. 4 November 2024. Retrieved 4 November 2024.
71. "'Stehen felsenfest an Seite der Ukraine'" (<https://www.tagesschau.de/ausland/europa/baerbock-kiew-besuch-100.html>). *tagesschau.de*. 4 November 2024. Retrieved 4 November 2024.
72. "South Korea 'not ruling out' sending weapons directly to Ukraine" (<https://www.france24.com/en/asia-pacific/20241107-south-korea-not-ruling-out-sending-weapons-directly-to-ukraine>). *France 24*. 7 November 2024.
73. "South Koreans oppose arms for Ukraine as envoy visits" (<https://www.reuters.com/world/south-koreans-remain-opposed-sending-arms-ukraine-2024-11-27/>). *Reuters*. 27 November 2024.

Further reading

- Cranny-Evans, Sam (6 May 2025). "Brothers in Arms: Assessing North Korea's Contribution to Russia's War in Ukraine" (<https://www.rusi.org/explore-our-research/publications/commentary/brothers-arms-assessing-north-koreas-contribution-russias-war-ukraine>). Royal United Service Institute. Retrieved 6 June 2025.

Retrieved from "[https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=North_Korean_involvement_in_the_Russo-Ukrainian_war_\(2022–present\)&oldid=1354925349](https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=North_Korean_involvement_in_the_Russo-Ukrainian_war_(2022–present)&oldid=1354925349)"